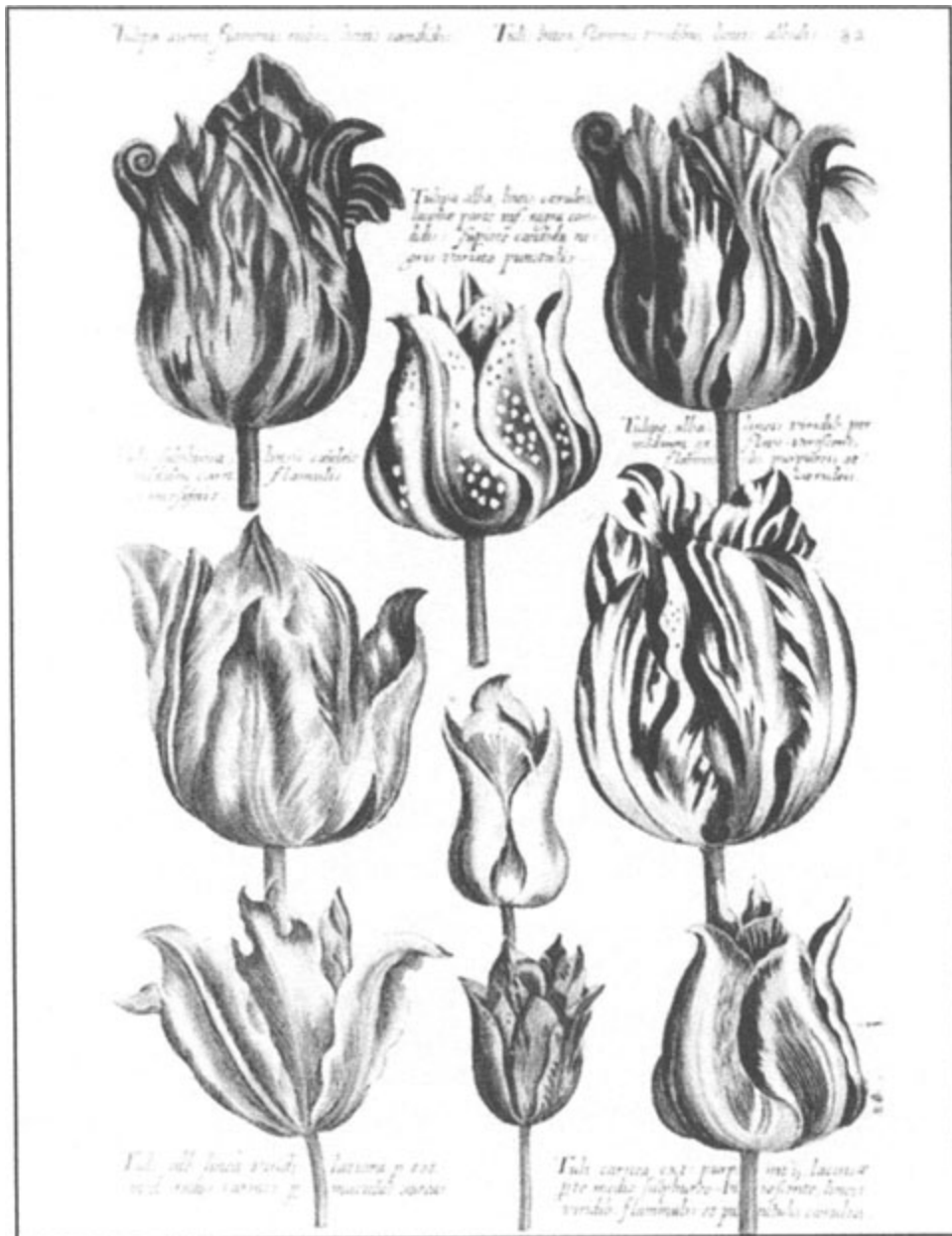




When Johann Theodore de Bry created this copperplate engraving in 1611 for a botanical book on new flowers called *Florilegium Novum*, he would have had little inkling that some of the bulbs would be worth \$25,000 to \$50,000 a mere 20 years later.

The speculation became more and more intense. A bulb might now change hands several times at steadily increasing and wonderfully rewarding prices while still unseen in the ground. And there were also some terrible accidents. Charles Mackay, in *Extraordinary Popular Delusions and the Madness of Crowds*, his classic book on speculation (and other departures from reason), tells gleefully a story first told in Blainville's *Travels*, that of a young sailor who, for bringing word of a shipment of